

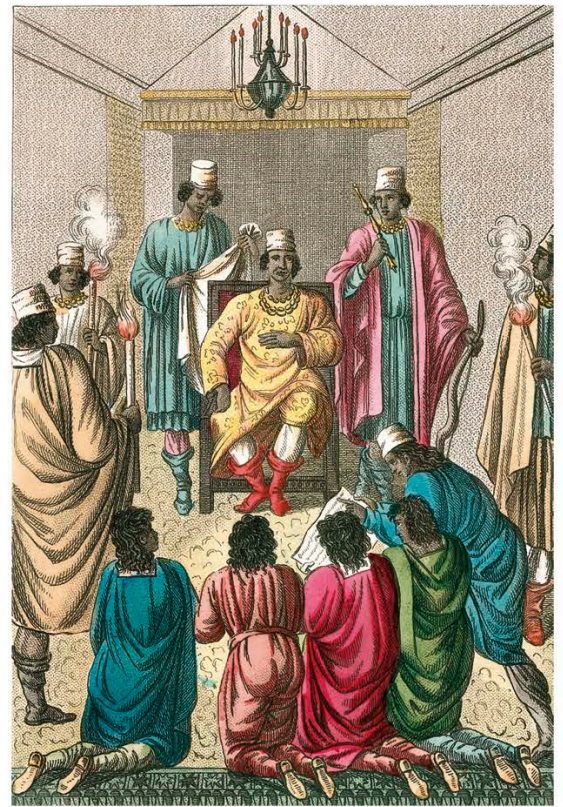


SONGHAI EMPIRE ▲

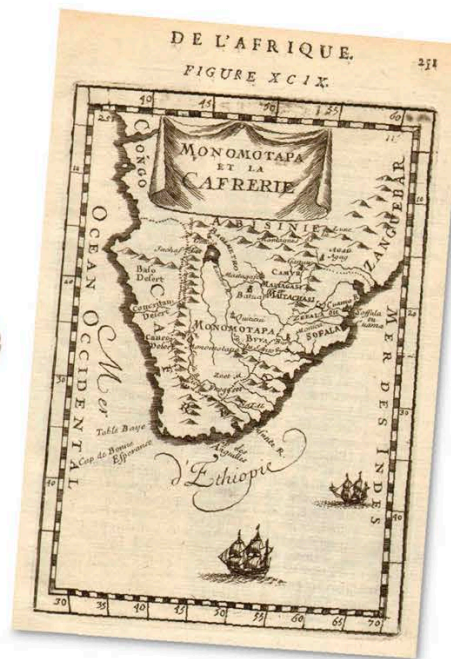
The Songhai Empire was one of West Africa's most powerful states. This tomb was built by Emperor Askia Mohammed in his capital Gao, in modern-day Mali. Gao's location on the Niger River allowed the empire to take control of the gold trade across the Sahara Desert.

KINGDOM OF KONGO ►

At its height, the Kingdom of Kongo, in present-day Angola, was the most powerful state in western Central Africa. The Kongo formed an alliance with the Dutch. Here the King of Kongo can be seen receiving Dutch ambassadors in 1642.



1450-1750



A 17TH-CENTURY MAP OF THE KINGDOM OF MUTAPA, ALSO KNOWN AS MONOMOTAPA

◀ KINGDOM OF MUTAPA

The vast southern African Kingdom of Mutapa spanned present-day Zimbabwe, Zambia, Mozambique, and South Africa. The kingdom grew wealthy trading gold and ivory to Islamic merchants on the East African coast, but civil wars led to its decline and the Portuguese took control in 1629.

ASANTE EMPIRE ►

Located in what is now modern-day Ghana, the Asante Empire was a thriving center of art and trade. The empire grew rich trading gold, ivory, and enslaved people. It was so rich that it earned the title "Kingdom of Gold," and gold dust was even used as currency.

